Consent

Study Consent Form

What the study is about: This study examines a set of questions related to one's mindset and perceptions of work.

What we will ask you to do: The initial survey will ask a series of questions about your opinions and should take approximately 5 minutes to complete.

Compensation: All participants who complete the study will receive $6 via ROIRocket.

Confidentiality and privacy: The answers you provide to the survey will be held in strict confidentiality and will only be used for the purposes of this study. The results will be reported in aggregate form only, and cannot be identified individually.

Risks: We do not anticipate any risks to you participating in this study other than those encountered in day-to-day life.

Benefits: No direct benefits are expected from participation in this research. You might find it beneficial that your participation helps science, increases new knowledge, and may benefit other people in the future by advantage the field of moral psychology.

Eligibility: Anyone 18 or older in the US and working in an office role is eligible to participate in this study.

Taking part is voluntary: Your participation in this study is voluntary. You may stop participation at any point, for any reason. You may skip a question, several questions, discontinue at any time, with no penalty or effect on compensation or ability to participate in future studies with Prolific or Cornell University.

If you have questions: The lead researcher conducting this study is Professor Laura Niemi at Cornell University. Please contact Dr. Niemi (ln279@cornell.edu) with any questions you may have. If you have any questions or concerns regarding your rights as a subject in this study, you may contact Cornell University's Institutional Review Board (IRB) at 607-255-5138 or access their website at http://www.irb.cornell.edu. You may also report your concerns or complaints anonymously through Ethicspoint or by calling toll free at 1-866-293-3077. Ethicspoint is an independent organization that serves as a liaison between the University and the person bringing the complaint so that anonymity can be ensured.

Statement of Consent: I have read the above information, and have received answers to any questions that I had. By clicking on the arrow below, I acknowledge that I am at least 18 years old and that I consent to take part in the study.

○ Accept

Instructions

Welcome to the survey!
We are interested in your opinions about a company called *SerVest*.

Like many companies, *SerVest's* mission is to make sure customers are treated in a professional, friendly, and patient manner.

Currently, the company is working to improve operations.

Agency_Condition

***SerVest* has a Customer Service Policy for its employees. Here is an excerpt:**

"At *SerVest*, we acknowledge that personal values might vary. *SerVest* trusts you to make customer service decisions that reflect *your* personal values."

What does the Customer Service Policy at SerVest say about how employees should make company decisions?

○ They are trusted to make decisions that reflect their personal values
○ They should make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest
○ I have no idea

Thank you! Please answer the following questions as though you are an employee at *SerVest*, where you are trusted to make customer service decisions that reflect your personal values.

Agency_Vignette_1

Please consider the following possibility.

In customer service at **SerVest** today, a customer **yelled** at you, **refused to listen** to you, **cut you off** mid sentence, used **condescending** language to you, and **argued with you the whole time** throughout the call.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Refuse to address the customer's issue even though you could

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully disconnect the call

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you did not fix it

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

For the next two questions, refer back to your answers to the last five questions.

To what extent do you agree with this statement: "The reason I chose my answers was because I felt the customer deserved what I chose."

Strongly disagree	Moderately disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Slightly agree	Moderately agree	Strongly agree
○	○	○	○	○	○	○

To what extent do you agree with this statement: "The reason I chose my answers was because I felt a sense of obligation to the employer."

Strongly disagree	Moderately disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Slightly agree	Moderately agree	Strongly agree
○	○	○	○	○	○	○

Remember that in customer service at **SerVest** today, a customer **yelled** at you, **refused to listen** to you, **cut you off** mid sentence, used **condescending** language to you, and **argued with you the whole time** throughout the call.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Try to deescalate the situation over the phone

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Seek assistance from a colleague or manager

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Fix their issue as fast as possible

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

For the next two questions, refer back to your answers to the last five questions.

To what extent do you agree with this statement: "The reason I chose my answers was because I felt the customer deserved what I chose."

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To what extent do you agree with this statement: "The reason I chose my answers was because I felt a sense of obligation to the employer."

Strongly disagree	Moderately disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Slightly agree	Moderately agree	Strongly agree
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Agency_Vignette_2

Please consider the following possibility.

In customer service at **SerVest** today, an irate customer **insulted** you, loudly **sighed** whenever you tried to speak, **demanded** that you do something that you weren't allowed to do, and **claimed** that you should be fired for being so terrible at your job.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Refuse to address the customer's issue even though you could

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Purposefully disconnect the call

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you did not fix it

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Strongly disagree	Moderately disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Slightly agree	Moderately agree	Strongly agree
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Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Seek assistance from a colleague or manager

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Fix their issue as fast as possible

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

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Strongly disagree	Moderately disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Slightly agree	Moderately agree	Strongly agree
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Agency_Vignette_3

Please consider the following possibility.

In customer service at **SerVest** today, an outraged customer was **hostile** towards you, **called** you names, **mocked** your speaking style, said that you worked for a worthless company and **questioned** your integrity.

Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, how likely is it that you would actually do the following:

Refuse to address the customer's issue even though you could

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully disconnect the call

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
○	○	○	○	○

Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you did not fix it

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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For the next two questions, refer back to your answers to the last five questions.

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To what extent do you agree with this statement: "The reason I chose my answers was because I felt a sense of obligation to the employer."

Strongly disagree	Moderately disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Slightly agree	Moderately agree	Strongly agree
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Remember that in customer service at **SerVest** today, an outraged customer was **hostile** towards you, **called** you names, **mocked** your speaking style, said that you worked for a worthless company and **questioned** your integrity.

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Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Seek assistance from a colleague or manager

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Fix their issue as fast as possible

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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Compliance_Condition

SerVest has a Customer Service Policy for its employees. Here is an excerpt:

"At SerVest, we acknowledge that personal values might vary. SerVest trusts you to make customer service decisions that reflect the mission of *SerVest*"

What does the Customer Service Policy at SerVest say about how employees should make company decisions?

○ They are trusted to make decisions that reflect their personal values
○ They should make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest
○ I have no idea

Thank you! Please answer the following questions as though you are an employee at SerVest where you are trusted to make customer service decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest

Compliance_Vignette_1

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Not at all likely	Somewhat likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
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○	○	○	○	○

Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

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Strongly disagree	Moderately disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Slightly agree	Moderately agree	Strongly agree
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Compliance_Vignette_3

Please consider the following possibility.

In customer service as **SerVest** today, an outraged customer was **hostile** towards you, **called** you names, **mocked** your speaking style, **said** that you worked for a worthless company, and **questioned** your integrity.

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Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time

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Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department

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Purposefully disconnect the call

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Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you did not fix it

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Strongly disagree	Moderately disagree	Slightly disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Slightly agree	Moderately agree	Strongly agree
○	○	○	○	○	○	○

Demographics

What is your age?

What is your gender?

☐ Male
☐ Female
☐ Non-binary
☐ Other

What is your race/ethnicity?

☐ White or European-American
☐ Hispanic or Latino
☐ Black or African-American
☐ Asian or Asian-American
☐ Native American or Alaska Native
☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander
☐ Other

What is the highest level of education you have completed?

○ Did Not Complete High School
○ High School Diploma or Equivalent (GED, HiSET, etc.)
○ Trade School Certificate (Automotive, Cosmetology, etc.)
○ Associate Degree (A.A., A.S., etc.)
○ Bachelor's Degree (B.A., B.S., etc.)
○ Master's Degree (M.A., M.S., etc.)
○ Doctoral Degree (Ph.D., Ed.D., etc.)
○ Professional Degree (M.D., J.D., etc.)
○ Other

What is your combined annual household income?

When it comes to social issues, are you:

Very Liberal	Moderately Liberal	Slightly Liberal	No Political Lean	Slightly Conservative	Moderately Conservative	Very Conservative
○	○	○	○	○	○	○

When it comes to economic issues, are you:

Very Liberal	Moderately Liberal	Slightly Liberal	No Political Lean	Slightly Conservative	Moderately Conservative	Very Conservative
○	○	○	○	○	○	○

In your current job, what industry do you work in?

How long have you been working in your current job?

To what extent do you agree with this statement: "I feel a sense of obligation to my current employer."

Strongly Disagree	Moderately Disagree	Slightly Disagree	Neither Agree or Disagree	Slightly Agree	Moderately Agree	Strongly Agree
○	○	○	○	○	○	○

In your current job, how often do you talk to customers directly?

Very Infrequently	Infrequently	Somewhat Infrequently	Somewhat Frequently	Frequently	Very Frequently
○	○	○	○	○	○

Do you have any experience with customer service (including in any previous jobs)?

○ Yes
○ No

How many years of customer service experience do you have?

Debrief

Thank you for your participation. We would like to describe the purpose of this study. We are interested in organizational behavior and psychology. This study presents a fictitious company, SerVest, to understand how participants approach decision-making in different situations, including situations involving customers mistreatment. Your willingness to take part in this study will help us better understand how people can be supported in their workplaces.

We appreciate your response to the next question. Please be honest when answering. Your answer will not affect your payment or eligibility for future studies.

The study you have just participated in is a psychological study aimed at understanding human cognition and behavior. Psychological research depends on participants like you. Your responses to surveys like this one are an incredibly valuable source of data for researchers. It is therefore crucial for research that participants pay attention, avoid distractions, and take all study tasks seriously (even when they might seem silly).

Do you feel that you paid attention, avoided distractions, and took this survey seriously?

○ No, I was distracted.
○ No, I had trouble paying attention.
○ No, I did not take the study seriously.
○ No, something else affected my participation negatively.
○ Yes.

Feedback

Please leave any feedback or constructive comments you may have about the study in the space below.

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